Pierriccardo Olivieri

Zurich, Switzerland | +39 331 738 1689 | pierriccardo.olivieri@polimi.it
Google Scholar | github.com/pierriccardo | linkedin.com/in/pierriccardo-olivieri

Student Researcher at **Google DeepMind** working on RL for LLM post-training, and final-year Ph.D. candidate in AI at **Politecnico di Milano** (Advisor: Prof. Nicola Gatti). Previously a Visiting Ph.D. Researcher at **UT Austin** (Advisor: Prof. Amy Zhang). My research focuses on **generalization in reinforcement learning**, particularly *unsupervised* and *continual RL*, and extending these principles to *LLM post-training*.

Research & Industry Experience

Google DeepMind Aug 2026 – Present
Student Research Intern (Host: Raynald Chung, CoHost: Martin Bölle) *Zurich, Switzerland*
- Researching reinforcement learning algorithms for LLM post-training, learning soft tokens as compressed instructions for personalized responses to improve inference efficiency and quality.
- Designing and scaling distributed RL post-training and evaluation pipelines in **JAX**.

The University of Texas at Austin – MIDI Lab Apr 2025 – Jul 2026
Visiting Ph.D. Researcher (Advisor: Prof. Amy Zhang) *Austin, TX, USA*
- Researched continual reinforcement learning via Behavioral Foundation Models (BFMs) and unsupervised representation learning for zero-shot task adaptation.

AIRIC (AI Research and Innovation Center) Sep 2022 – Feb 2023
AI Research Engineer *Milan, Italy*
- Developed applied research solutions for industrial planning algorithms and LLM fine-tuning (**Stack:** Python, PyTorch, Rust, Docker).

Virtual B s.r.l. Jan 2022 – Jul 2022
Machine Learning Engineer Intern *Milan, Italy*
- Built and deployed an end-to-end ML recommendation pipeline on AWS, reducing inference latency from hours to minutes (**Stack:** Python, Docker, AWS).

Publications (* *equal contribution*)

Conference Proceedings

[**ICML 2026**] T. Giorgi, **P. Olivieri**, M. Papini. *Impact of Connectivity on Laplacian Representations in Reinforcement Learning.*

[**AAAI 2026 – Oral**] **P. Olivieri**, F. Lasca, A. Gianola, M. Papini. *Do it for HER: First-order Logic Reward Specification in Reinforcement Learning.* [**Code**]

[**CDC 2025**] **P. Olivieri**, A. Sanchini, R. Spica, N. Gatti, S. Formentin. *Precision UAV Formation Control via PGPE-enhanced NMPC.* 64th IEEE Conference on Decision and Control.

[**AAAI 2024**] D. Maran*, **P. Olivieri***, F. E. Stradi*, G. Urso, N. Gatti, M. Restelli. *Online Markov Decision Processes Configuration with Continuous Decision Space.*

[**NeurIPS 2022**] B. H. Zhang, L. Carminati, F. Cacciamani, G. Farina, **P. Olivieri**, N. Gatti, T. Sandholm. *Subgame Solving in Adversarial Team Games.*

Selected Workshop Papers

[**RLC Workshop 2026**] **P. Olivieri**, S. Agarwal, A. Zhang. *Continual Reinforcement Learning via Behavioral Foundation Models.* Continual Reinforcement Learning Workshop at RLC.

[**ICML Workshop 2024**] **P. Olivieri**, M. Castiglioni, N. Gatti. *Delayed Adversarial Attacks on Stochastic Multi-Armed Bandits.* ICML Workshop on Aligning RL Experimentalists and Theorists (ARLET).

Education

Politecnico di Milano 2022 – Present
Ph.D. in Artificial Intelligence (Advisor: Prof. Nicola Gatti) *Milan, Italy*
- Research Focus: Generalization in Reinforcement Learning, Unsupervised Representation Learning, Online & Multi-Agent Learning.

Politecnico di Milano 2019 – 2022
M.Sc. in Computer Science & Engineering *Milan, Italy*
- **Thesis:** *Algorithms for Subgame Solving in Adversarial Team Games* (Advisor: Prof. Nicola Gatti).

Politecnico di Milano 2015 – 2019
B.Sc. in Computer Science & Engineering *Milan, Italy*

Awards, Academic Service & Skills

- **Honors & Service:** ICML 2026 Golden Reviewer (Top 25%); Reviewer for NeurIPS, ICML, ICLR, and AAAI.
- **Supervision & Teaching:** Co-supervised 4 M.Sc. thesis students at Politecnico di Milano; Teaching Assistant for Informatics in C (30 hours, 2023–2024).
- **Technical Stack:** Python, JAX, PyTorch, Rust, C, Docker, AWS, Git, Distributed RL & LLM Post-Training.
- **Languages:** Italian (Native), English (Fluent).